

The Magic Pen

THE Battle of Haldighati was fought between the Mughal Empire and the forces of Mewar on June 21, 1576, at Haldighati in Rajasthan, India.

It was a **decisive** victory for the Mughal Emperor Akbar's general Raja Man Singh against Maharana Pratap Singh of Mewar.'

Akshat **stared** at what he had just written. It was **incredible**.

"I didn't know this!"

Akshat hated history, especially memorising dates. He checked from the book in front of him and found that the facts were correct!

He remembered putting his head over the book and **dozing off**.

So, when did he write the answer?

The extraordinarily beautiful pen he'd discovered in the desk **lay glinting** on the notebook.

Akshat's family had just shifted to this house. His room still didn't seem like his own.

At times he had a **strange** sensation that he was in somebody else's room.

In fact, when he told Ravi Bhaiyya about it he **collapsed** laughing,

"You'd say you see **shadowy** figures **hovering** around, next...."

That, of course, he did—but didn't have the **courage** to tell his brother or anyone for fear of being laughed at.

Once he had woken up in the middle of the night and was shocked to see a boy, about his own age, **fiddling** with the drawers of the old roll-top desk.

"Hey! Who're you?" he asked, his voice **melting away** in **fright** as the boy **vanished** into thin air.

When he got up in the morning, Akshat **wondered** if it had all been a dream.

He went up to the desk where he had seen the boy fiddling and **tugged** at the handle.

Lo! It **slid** open and a beautiful **crystal-studded** pen rolled forward.

It now became his History Pen.

It worked beautifully!

Akshat was **in seventh heaven** as he started doing well in the exams.

However, the biggest surprise came when he was chatting with the old History teacher, Jha Sir, who gave him extra coaching.

"So, how are you liking it here?" he asked.

"Good, quite good," Akshat replied **guardedly**.

"You are doing well now. One day you will also become like Sarthak."

"Who is that sir?"

"Ask 'who was that?' He was my best student. A gem of a boy whose father owned the house in which you are living now, and what a genius he was at History! And do you know what his only **regret** was?"



Akshat **shook his head**.

“**Unlike** yours, his handwriting was so bad that he lost marks though he was brilliant! So he kept wishing for a magic pen!”

Jha Sir was so involved in the story that he didn't notice Akshat start at the word 'magic.'

“A pen that could write **legibly** and beautifully. Poor boy! It was so unfortunate that he **drowned** in a pond, his wish unfulfilled,” he said in a low voice.

Akshat returned to his room trying to **piece together** whatever he heard about Sarthak and the vision at night.

Was Sarthak trying to realise his dream through him—giving him the pen that had all the historical data in place?

As Akshat started scoring well in history and made his family proud, he was **ecstatic**.

When his class teacher **praised** him for the rapid progress that Akshat had made in history saying he must be working really hard, Akshat felt **pangs** of guilt.

Then he decided he would really work hard—with support from 'Sarthak.'

Gradually, he started liking history.

As the days passed, he enjoyed history **to such an extent** that he started writing historical **fiction**, ably **assisted** by the magic pen.

What a proud moment it was for him when his collection of stories was published one day!

Akshat, the teen author, dedicated the book to 'Sarthak'—and everyone wondered who Sarthak was!

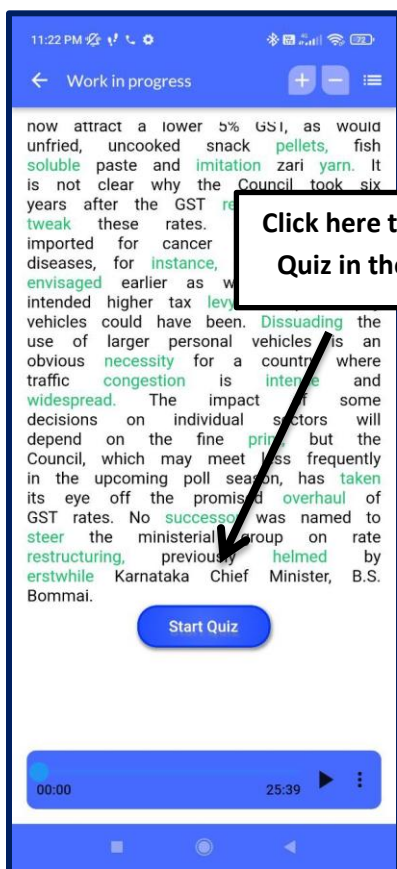
Vocabulary

1. **Decisive** (adjective) – conclusive, critical, definite, clear-cut, final निर्णायक
2. **Stare** (at) (verb) – gaze, look fixedly, gawk, peer, goggle घूरना
3. **Incredible** (adjective) – unbelievable, amazing, astonishing, wonderful, mind-blowing अविश्वसनीय
4. **Doze off** (phrasal verb) – fall asleep, nap, snooze, drift off, slumber झपकी लेना
5. **Lay** (verb) – place, put, set, position, rest रखना
6. **Glinting** (adjective) – shining, sparkling, gleaming, twinkling, glimmering चमकता हुआ
7. **At times** (phrase) – occasionally, sometimes, from time to time, now and then, intermittently कभी-कभी
8. **Strange** (adjective) – unusual, odd, weird, bizarre, peculiar अजीब
9. **Collapse** (verb) – fall down, break down, faint, crumple, tumble गिर पड़ना / हँसते-हँसते लोटपोट होना
10. **Shadowy** (adjective) – dim, indistinct, dark, vague, ghostly धुंधला / छायायुक्त
11. **Hover** (verb) – float, linger, drift, stay suspended, remain nearby मंडराना
12. **Courage** (noun) – bravery, boldness, fearlessness, valour, nerve साहस
13. **Fiddling** (noun) – tinkering, tampering, meddling, handling, adjusting छेड़छाड़
14. **Melt away** (phrasal verb) – disappear, fade, vanish, dissolve, evaporate गायब हो जाना
15. **Fright** (noun) – fear, terror, panic, alarm, shock डर
16. **Vanish** (verb) – disappear, fade, evaporate, melt away, dematerialize गायब हो जाना
17. **Wonder** (verb) – ponder, think, speculate, question, marvel आश्चर्य करना / सोच में पड़ जाना
18. **Tug** (verb) – pull, jerk, drag, haul, yank खींचना
19. **Slide** (verb) – slip, move smoothly, glide, coast, slither सरकना
20. **Crystal-studded** (adjective) – jeweled, decorated with crystals, embellished, ornate, adorned with gems क्रिस्टल से जड़ा हुआ
21. **In seventh heaven** (phrase) – extremely happy, overjoyed, elated, delighted, ecstatic बहुत प्रसन्न होना

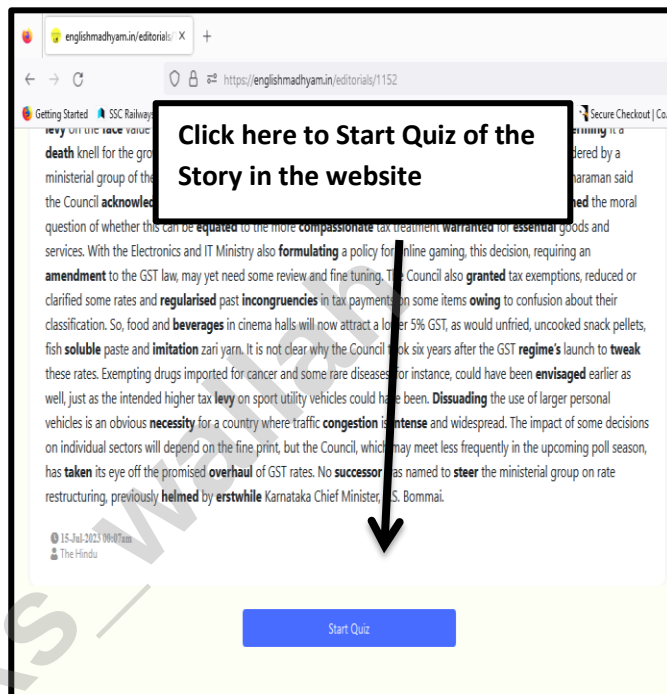
22. **Guardedly** (adverb) – cautiously, carefully, warily, circumspectly, prudently सावधानी से
23. **Regret** (noun) – sorrow, remorse, guilt, repentance, lamentation पछतावा
24. **Shake one's head** (phrase) – indicate 'no', disapprove, deny, express disbelief, negate सिर हिलाकर मना करना
25. **Unlike** (preposition) – different from, dissimilar to, in contrast to, opposite to, not like के विपरीत
26. **Legibly** (adverb) – clearly, readably, understandably, neatly, plainly साफ-साफ (लिखना)
27. **Drown** (verb) – sink, submerge, go under, suffocate in water, perish डूबना
28. **Piece together** (phrase) – assemble, reconstruct, deduce, figure out, understand जोड़कर समझना
29. **Ecstatic** (adjective) – overjoyed, elated, thrilled, euphoric, delighted अत्यंत प्रसन्न
30. **Praise** (verb) – commend, compliment, admire, applaud, appreciate प्रशंसा करना
31. **Pangs** (noun) – twinges, feelings, stabs, sharp pains, spasms वेदना / टीस
32. **To such an extent** (phrase) – so much, so greatly, so far, deeply, significantly इतनी हद तक
33. **Fiction** (noun) – story, tale, narrative, invention, imaginary writing काल्पनिक कथा / उपन्यास
34. **Assist** (verb) – help, support, aid, guide, cooperate मदद करना

@mocks_wallah

Practice Exercise



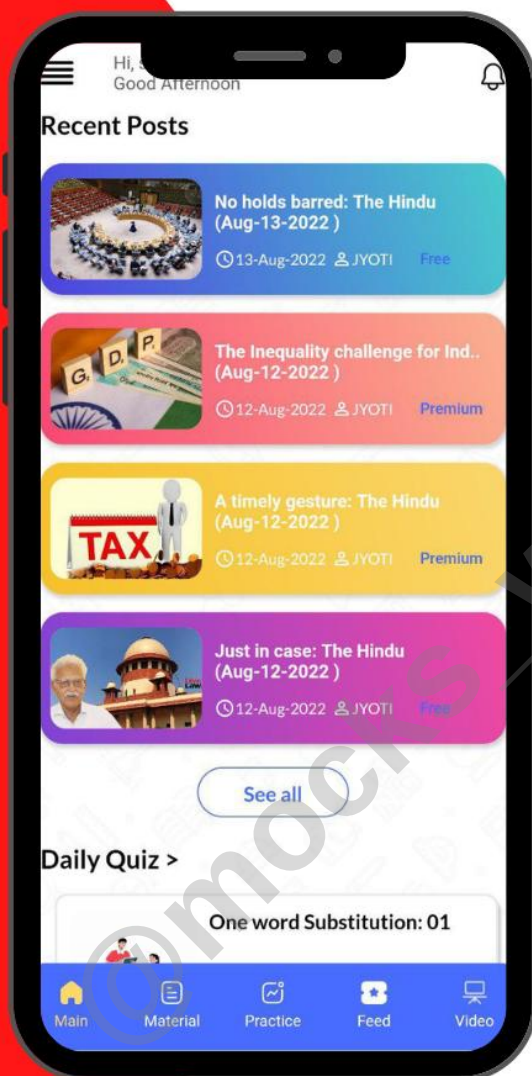
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